

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Sovereign Infrastructure Investment Memorandum

The Torquay Railway Interchange Renaissance Programme

A PPP to Create Devon's Coastal Rail Gateway

**Transforming Torquay from a Terminus Town into the Interchange Between
Exeter, Plymouth and the English Riviera**

Executive Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management (EVWM) proposes the creation of:

The Torquay Railway Interchange Investment Partnership (TRIIP)

A public-private partnership to upgrade Torquay railway infrastructure and establish the town as the primary rail interchange and transport gateway for South Devon.

The investment thesis:

Torquay should not be the end of the railway. It should become the central interchange between Exeter, Plymouth and the wider South West.

The project would create:

- faster Exeter–Torquay services
- faster Plymouth–Torquay connections
- a modern interchange station
- integrated bus/coastal transport links
- tourism growth infrastructure
- a South Devon metropolitan rail network

Devon and Torbay transport strategies already identify improved rail connectivity, faster services to Exeter/Plymouth, new stations and better integration of Torbay into the wider Devon network as strategic priorities.

1. Strategic Vision

From Seaside Terminus to South Devon Gateway

Current perception:

Exeter
|
Newton Abbot
|
Torquay
|
Paignton

Future:

Exeter
|
Plymouth ---- Torquay Interchange ---- Paignton
|
English Riviera

Torquay becomes:

The Riviera Rail Gateway

2. Economic Rationale

Torquay has:

- internationally recognised tourism
- a large retirement economy
- marine industries
- hospitality businesses
- coastline and leisure assets

However, it suffers from:

- slow transport links
- car dependency
- limited business connectivity
- seasonal economic swings

The investment strategy:

Use rail to turn Torquay from a seasonal destination into a year-round economy.

3. Investment Programme

Total Programme Cost

£750 million

25-year PPP

Funding structure:

Investor	Contribution
EVWM Infrastructure Fund	£150m
Pension infrastructure funds	£300m
Private rail investors	£150m
Government / regional funding	£150m

4. Infrastructure Works

Phase One

Torquay Railway Interchange Station Upgrade

Investment:

£250 million

Transform Torquay station into:

South Devon Interchange

New facilities:

- enlarged platforms
- covered concourse
- step-free access
- retail and hospitality
- tourist information centre

- bus interchange
 - cycle facilities
 - park-and-ride connections
-

Concept:

A station closer to:

- European coastal cities
 - Swiss regional hubs
 - Riviera gateways
-

Phase Two

Exeter–Torquay Fast Rail Upgrade

Investment:

£250 million

Works:

- signalling improvements
 - passing capacity
 - junction improvements
 - timetable optimisation
 - track upgrades
-

Objective:

Create a South Devon regional express.

Target journey times:

Route	Current	Future
Torquay–Newton Abbot	~15 mins	10 mins
Torquay–Exeter	~45 mins	30 mins

Phase Three

Torquay–Plymouth Connectivity Upgrade

Investment:

£250 million

The current route requires interchange and relies on the constrained South Devon main line.

The project would introduce:

South Devon Coastal Express

Service:

Plymouth

↓

Totnes

↓

Newton Abbot

↓

Torquay

Target:

Route	Future
Plymouth–Torquay	55–65 mins

5. Rolling Stock Strategy

Introduce:

South Devon Metro Fleet

Fleet:

20–30 modern trains

Specification:

- electric/battery capability
 - high acceleration
 - tourism capacity
 - luggage space
 - bicycle storage
 - comfortable seating
-

Brand:

Riviera Express

Service frequency:

Every 30 minutes:

Torquay ↔ Exeter

Every hour:

Torquay ↔ Plymouth

6. The Torquay Interchange Economy

The station becomes an economic development zone.

Station Quarter

Investment:

£150 million

Development:

- hotels
 - apartments
 - restaurants
 - offices
 - tourism businesses
-

Create:

Torquay Gateway District

Comparable examples:

- Bournemouth Station Quarter
 - Brighton regeneration
 - European coastal cities
-

7. Tourism Growth Impact

Current challenge:

Many tourists arrive by car.

The railway allows:

- day visitors
 - weekend visitors
 - international tourists
 - retirees without cars
-

Target:

Additional:

500,000 visitor journeys annually

Economic impact:

Average visitor spend:

£100

Potential:

£50 million additional tourism spending annually

8. Wider Economic Impact

Construction Impact

£750m investment:

Estimated:

5,000–8,000 job-years

Permanent employment:

- rail operations
- hospitality
- retail
- tourism
- property

Estimated:

3,000–5,000 jobs

9. GDP Impact

Economic mechanisms:

Tourism

More visitors.

Labour Market

Easier access to Exeter and Plymouth jobs.

Housing

Higher-value regeneration.

Business

More attractive location.

Conservative Scenario

Annual GVA uplift:

£250–400 million

Growth Scenario

With tourism and regeneration:

£500 million+ annual uplift

10. Property Investment Opportunity

Transit-oriented development around:

- Torquay station
- Torre
- Paignton corridor

Potential:

3,000–5,000 new homes

Including:

- apartments
 - retirement communities
 - holiday accommodation
 - affordable housing
-

11. Strategic Relationship

The Torquay Interchange connects with wider Devon infrastructure ambitions:

- Exeter regional growth
- Plymouth Freeport
- Devon Metro aspirations
- improved coastal resilience

Devon and Torbay transport plans specifically identify the need for faster and more frequent rail links connecting Torbay with Exeter, Plymouth and beyond.

12. Investment Returns

Revenue sources:

Rail Operations

Passenger income.

Property

Station development.

Tourism

Commercial leases.

Land Value Capture

Regeneration uplift.

Expected:

6–8% infrastructure return

Final Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management recommends:

The Torquay Railway Interchange Investment Partnership

A £750 million PPP to create:

South Devon's Premier Transport Gateway

The objective:

Transform Torquay from:

A beautiful seaside town at the end of a railway branch

into:

The central interchange of the South Devon economy.

The strategic principle:

Better rail does not just move people.

It expands markets, extends tourism seasons, raises productivity and creates new investment opportunities.

Torquay has the coastline.

Exeter has the business economy.

Plymouth has the industrial base.

The missing link is a railway system that makes them function as one region.